Transmission Delay — Full Lyrics Collection

Written and Performed by Nova Kai & Renald

■ Dock 6, Bay 9

New badge, new route, breath held tight,
ticket stamped for the endless night.
The hangar hums, a thousand suns,
blinking like they’ve just begun.

Ground crew waves in vapor mist,
I kiss my luck, it doesn’t kiss.
Burn sequence sings, my hands still shake—
the stars don’t care what risks I take.

They said it’s easy once you leave,
just drop, collect, don’t dare believe.

Dock 6, Bay 9,
my pulse is a launch alarm.
Goodbye gravity,
hello empty charm.
A message pings—soft, low, benign:
"Hey rookie courier… don’t get lost this time."

"Nova Kai—en route. Wish me luck."

■ Delivery to Luma-9

Biolight drips from the swamp-sky trees,
corporate labs hum, allergic to me.
"Sign right here," the scientist sneers,
his gloves worth more than my year’s arrears.

My boots sink deep in the profit mud,
cargo leaks a violet flood.
He scans my tag, rejects my name,
says, "rookie couriers are all the same."

And I laugh through clenched design,
"Guess rain don’t count as fine."
You can’t refund time,
on Luma-9.

The receipt won’t post, the system’s late,
I hum old Earth tunes and curse the gate.
A beetle-drone steals half my pay—
must be Tuesday, light-years away.

Fuel low, credits thin,
I message him again—
"Still alive. You’d hate this smell."

You can’t refund time,
on Luma-9.

■ Echo Market Blues

Neon tongues and counterfeit moons,
traders bark in crooked tunes.
I pawn my boots for docking rights,
eat smoke and sound for nights on nights.

Bought a meal that never came,
bartender charged me for the blame.
A mimic laughed, then took my seat—
said "you’re learning, kid—repeat defeat."

Sold my lunch for docking time,
hunger’s cheaper than a fine.
Echo Market blues,
and no one leaves on time.

A pirate preacher played the keys,
blessing hustlers on their knees.
I tipped him hope, he tipped me lies—
"Girl, paradise is just supplies."

"Hey Renald — still alive. Barely.
You’d hate this smell."

Echo Market blues,
I keep the change, I keep the bruise.
And maybe someday when credits align,
I’ll buy back all that wasn’t mine.

■ The Holo Diner at Titan Gate

Neon syrup, coffee black,
glass booths hum with data crack.
I sit beside a freight-line ghost,
steam and silence make the toast.

He says, "First run? You’ve got that shine.
Give it a month—turn nickel to brine."
His badge is older than the wars,
his eyes still track departing doors.

He stirred his coffee, black as space,
said "the mail don’t love your face."
"Don’t trust the quiet jobs," he sighed,
"They’ll eat your soul from the inside."

I asked his name; he grinned, "Call me None.
Names burn up before they’re done."
He left a tip of cosmic dust—
I left with caffeine and mistrust.

Somewhere Renald’s message waits,
I replay it between the plates.
"Show me the stars," he’d said one night—
guess this diner’s close to light.

He stirred his coffee, black as space,
advice that time can’t erase.
I fly again with what he gave:
a map of warnings, and a wave.

■ Cold Cargo Run

Frost on the dash, breath turns slow,
heat core flickers, pale blue glow.
The ship smells like metal and fear,
I hum to fill the silent sphere.

Charts blur out, the nav drifts wide,
hunger hums like static inside.
The stars are beautiful, cruel, and dumb—
they burn, they shine, they never come.

Every ping a maybe, every crackle a sign,
Renald’s voice fades between the lines.

Cold cargo run,
half a tank and a setting sun.
I dream of food that isn’t paste,
and warmth that isn’t waste.
Cold cargo run,
I count the stars for one.

Docking logs say "Two more days,"
I barter prayers for gamma rays.
A flicker—his voice through static hum:
"Nova, don’t quit now… you’re almost home."

"Renald… if you can hear me—
tell me what color the sun is where you are."

Cold cargo run,
I chase ghosts through a dying sun.
Cold cargo run,
still pretending someone’s on the other end.

■ The Smuggler’s Port of Virel

Virel spins slow, a shadowed hive,
ports like scars where outlaws thrive.
The dockhand smiles with half a jaw,
"No questions, kid — just sign the law."

Cargo seal’s not on the list,
payment wired through a backdoor twist.
The credits glow, I dim my eyes,
a paycheck’s worth a little lie.

I tell myself it’s just a run,
everyone cheats beneath the sun.

Smuggler’s port,
no clean hands, no last resort.
They pay in silence, stare like glass,
I drift through customs, let it pass.

Bought a meal that tasted like sin,
cheap and warm, I gave in.
The captain next table raised his glass,
said, "first dirty job’s the one that lasts."

"Renald, you ever done something just to eat?"
(pause, static) "Never mind."

Smuggler’s port,
no names, no comfort, short report.
The credits clear, the guilt does not,
another night I should’ve fought.

I lock the hatch, I close the file,
whisper, "just this once," with a brittle smile.
Virel fades, my conscience hums—
the stars keep quiet. Everyone does.

■ Return Burn

Thrusters flare in silver lines,
homebound, broke, out of time.
The ship complains, my bones agree,
space gets loud when it’s just me.

I count the routes, the debts, the lies,
the friends I left, the quiet goodbyes.
Each beacon blinks a memory burned,
each one whispers, "no return."

Renald said "wait for me at Sol,"
I set my course, I set my soul.

Return burn, all systems ache,
chasing ghosts for connection’s sake.
Return burn, my ship runs lean,
carrying hope through the in-between.

Dock codes flicker, route unclean,
my messages bounce off dead machines.
One transmission loops his name,
his voice distorted, never the same.

"Renald… if you’re still out there…
I’ll be at the Sol relay. Two days. Don’t be late."

Return burn,
stars blur into one long line.
Return burn,
I’ll find you — or I’ll lie.

■ Message Failed to Send

Dock lights shimmer, relay hums,
I wait where every signal comes.
I’ve sent a dozen pings your way,
each one vanishes into gray.

Bought a drink I couldn’t taste,
time drips slow, nothing to waste.
Voices pass, they’re not your tone,
I check the logs — I’m still alone.

Your promise replays,
two days, two days.
I count them out,
they fade away.

Message failed to send,
no reply to amend.
I waited till the stars went dim,
still pretending I heard from him.

I play your voice through static hiss,
a ghost in wires, a half-sent kiss.
The system blinks—final receipt:
"User offline. Connection complete."

"Renald… you there?
You can say goodbye, you know.
Or don’t.
I’ll deliver the silence myself."

Message failed to send,
I’m out of routes to bend.
The stars don’t wait, they just begin,
I fade, I float, I breathe you in.

■ Hidden Track — The Long Delay

I kept the channel open,
long after it died.
Thought maybe silence could reply.

I kept the file unsent,
afraid to say goodbye.
Thought maybe ghosts could try.

Two signals lost in time delay,
chasing echoes that drift away.
I speak, you fade,
I fade, you stay—
caught in the long delay.

Your name loops soft through the static hum,
a melody I can’t outrun.
You said, "Stars don’t show, they shine,"
now I see that light was mine.

The void remembers every word,
even ones it never heard.
You said you’d meet me at the sun,
maybe you did — maybe we’re one.

We send, we wait,
through miles of fate.
The line goes dead,
but it’s not too late.
The heart still knows,
though time decays—
love is just a long delay.

"You weren’t ghosted. You were golden."
"You weren’t late. I just left too soon."
"Maybe arrival was never the point."

Our messages cross the endless sea,
you’re everywhere I used to be.
No end, no send, no words to say—
only the sound of a long delay.

"You always were faster than light."
"And you… were the echo worth waiting for."